



YouTube music pre-installed

Google will be including YouTube music as one of the default apps to come installed on Android. <https://dgit.in/oct19-69>



Unpatchable jailbreak

A security researcher "axiomX" released 'checkm8', an unpatchable jailbreak exploit for Apple A5 to A11 chips. <https://dgit.in/oct19-70>

ROG Strix Scope

Simple is better

With the ROG Strix Scope, Asus has decided to forgo the frills and get straight to the point. A gaming keyboard that sticks to the essentials. Let's see how it fares.



Features and accessories

In terms of features, the ROG Strix Scope doesn't pack a lot of additional features. It does however, have the essential features you'd expect from a gaming mechanical keyboard. Full n-key rollover, a polling rate of 1000 Hz, and macros are available through the software. The Strix Scope can also record macros on-the-fly. In addition to

being able to lock the windows key, you can switch between the function and media keys as well by pressing the Fn + Ins keys. There's also a 'stealth' button on the Strix Scope, which basically functions like a Win + D key, which is the shortcut for 'show desktop'. Upon pressing the stealth key, it hides all apps and even mutes audio.

In addition to macros, you can use the software to setup profiles as well, which can easily be switched using the Fn + 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, or 6 keys.

Inside the box, in addition to a plastic keycap remover, we got two extra control keys (the large ones), in different colours, black and grey, in addition to the red control keycap already on the keyboard.

Gaming and typing performance

We had no issues while using the ROG Strix Scope during gaming. It was responsive and comfortable to use. It was able to keep up with our rage-inducing gaming sessions and button spamming with ease. Again, we're not too sure about the extra large control key, but it didn't really hinder our in-game performance. We didn't mess around with the macros for two reasons. For one, we don't really use macros too often while

gaming, and two, using the software to set up macros is a hassle.

The Cherry MX Red keys feel good to type with. If you're a fan of tactile feedback, you might want to opt for the MX Blue or Brown variants. Overall, we liked the feel of the keys, and the key presses felt and sounded pretty satisfying. The keys are also slightly quieter than other mechanical keyboards which is a plus in our books.

Bottomline

The ROG Strix Scope is the latest entrant into ROG's gaming keyboard line-up and is targeted mostly at FPS gamers. Right out of the box, it's a good-looking and sturdy keyboard. The matte finish PBT keycaps also add to the good looks of the keyboard, while also offering even more durability.

The keyboard comes with Cherry MX Red keys, which are fairly common, and easy to type and game on. The standout in the keyboard layout is the extra large control key on the bottom left, which is twice the size of a regular control key. It took some getting used to the size of the control key and we didn't really see the point of making it larger. None of us at the test labs had any qualms with the default size of the control key. Nevertheless, if that is something you were looking for in a keyboard, the ROG Strix Scope has it.

When it comes to software, the ROG Armoury II needs some work, it's often slow and not very user-friendly. It supports custom profiles, you can assign macros here and if you go for the RGB variant, you would control light profiles here. Overall, the ROG Strix Scope is a decent and compact gaming keyboard with good aesthetics at a reasonable price-point without all the frills that come attached with gaming keyboards.

—Manish Rajesh

Build quality and design

The Strix Scope PBT features a brushed-aluminum design on the right-side while the left side is plain. The whole top of the keyboard chassis is black aluminium. In addition to looking premium, that also gives it a nice sturdy feel. The back is hard plastic and there are two foldable plastic top feet to provide some elevation.

The review unit we got uses Cherry MX Red keys but the Scope has plenty of switch options available. The Cherry MX Red keys are pretty standard fare. They feel good to type on. There's no tactile feedback as expected and the sound the keys make while typing is nice. These are in no way silent keys though. We had no issues with them while gaming either. We did face an issue because of the enlarged control key though, where we'd find ourselves pressing the windows + tab keys instead of alt + tab because of the shift in the layout. We did eventually get used to the size of the control key, however, we're still unsure if it actually makes a difference.

The ROG Strix Scope uses PBT keycaps, which are far more sturdy and durable than ABS keycaps, which most of the keyboards in this price segment use. There are three colours of keycaps on the board, with the majority being grey, followed by a sprinkling of black keys and finally, a select few reds. The red keycaps appeared to be double shot.

The Strix Scope comes with a braided cable, and there are grooves on either side of the back for the cable to fit into for some cable management.



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SPECIFICATIONS

KEYBOARD SIZE: Standard 104 key layout, Numpad included | KEYBOARD BACKLIGHTING: None | SWITCH TYPE: Mechanical (Cherry MX Red, 50 million lifecycle) | POLLING RATE: 1000Hz (1 ms) | KEY-ROLLOVER: N-key rollover | INTERFACE: USB 2.0 | DIMENSIONS: Width - 44 cm, Length - 13.7 cm, Height - 3.9 cm

CONTACT

ASUS ROG | PHONE: 1800-2090365 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: www.asus.com/in/